

► STRING PIECING

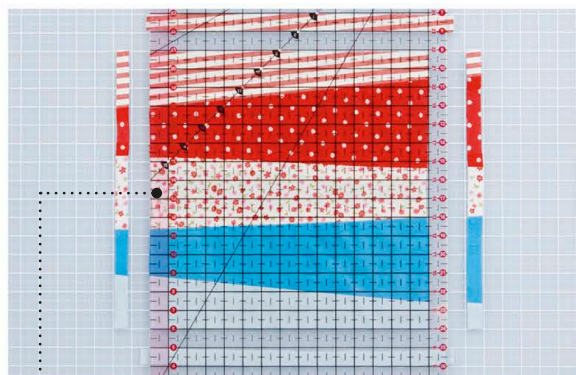
String piecing is similar to strip piecing, but the lengths of fabric are not necessarily straight strips and are referred to as “strings”. The string-pieced blocks can be combined to make larger units.

METHOD 1



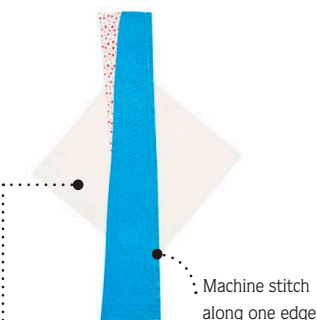
- 1 Select “strings” of fabric with plenty of colour and pattern contrast. With right sides together, stitch them together lengthways, leaving a 6mm ($\frac{1}{4}$ in) seam allowance. Alternate the angle as you add each piece and alternate the direction of stitching each time to prevent bowing.

If using a paper foundation block for Method 2, use a stitch length of around 1.5 to perforate the paper making it easier to remove.

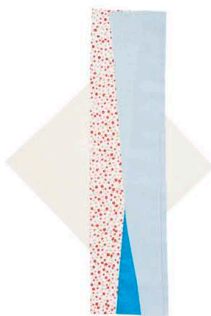


- 2 Press the seams to one side. Using a rotary cutter and quilter's ruler, trim the piece to the desired size and shape.

METHOD 2



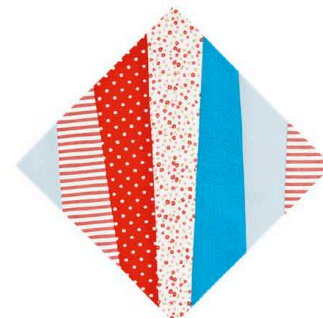
- 1 Cut a muslin or paper foundation block, plus seam allowances. Place the first string right side up in the centre of the block and lay the second string right side down on top. Make sure both strings are longer than the block at its widest point. Machine stitch along one edge of the strips through all layers. Flip the joined pieces open and press.



- 2 Turn the foundation block, then add a new string, right side down, to the free edge of the first string. Flip the joined pieces open and press.



- 3 Continue to add strings, flip, press, and stitch, until the foundation block is covered. Trim the edges level with the foundation. If you have used a paper foundation, leave a 6mm ($\frac{1}{4}$ in) allowance when you trim.



- 4 Carefully tear away the paper foundation, if used. A muslin foundation will remain in place. Press.